THE DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE (1707–1740S)

SCOPE: DECLINE OF COMMAND → CHRONOLOGY FROM AURANGZEB TO → SUCCESSION INSTABILITY: THRONE BECOMES → FACTIONS AND THE SAYYID → JAGIRDARI VOCABULARY PREVENTS CATEGORY → FISCAL-MILITARY FEEDBACK LOOP

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◈ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

SCOPE: DECLINE OF COMMAND, NOT DISAPPEARANCE

DECLINE OF COMMAND, NOT DISAPPEARANCE · IMPERIAL COMMAND WEAKENS; DYNASTY, TITLES AND PERSIANATE GRAMMAR ENDURE · CORE WINDOW · SUCCESSION, FACTIONS, JAGIRS, REGIONS AND NADIR SHAH TO THE · NOT THE CLAIM · INSTANT 1707 COLLAPSE, UNIVERSAL INDIAN DECLINE OR COMPANY INEVITABILITY · ANSWER RULE · DISTINGUISH ENFORCEABLE AUTHORITY FROM SYMBOLIC LEGITIMACY.

1707 → imperial command weakens; dynasty, titles and Persianate grammar endure

CORE WINDOW → succession, factions, jagirs, regions and Nadir Shah to the 1740s → NOT THE CLAIM → instant 1707 collapse, universal Indian decline or Company inevitability → ANSWER RULE → distinguish enforceable authority from symbolic legitimacy.

CORE CLAIM
- 1707 → imperial command weakens; dynasty, titles and Persianate grammar endure
- CORE WINDOW → succession, factions, jagirs, regions and Nadir Shah to the 1740s

MECHANISM
- NOT THE CLAIM → instant 1707 collapse, universal Indian decline or Company inevitability
- ANSWER RULE → distinguish enforceable authority from symbolic legitimacy.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1707 → imperial command weakens; dynasty, titles and Persianate grammar endure
- CORE WINDOW → succession, factions, jagirs, regions and Nadir Shah to the 1740s

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER RULE → distinguish enforceable authority from symbolic legitimacy.

01

STAGE 01

CHRONOLOGY FROM AURANGZEB TO THE 1740S

CHRONOLOGY FROM AURANGZEB TO THE 1740S · 1707 AURANGZEB DIES · BAHADUR SHAH I 1707-12 · JAHANDAR SHAH 1712-13 · 1713 FARRUKHSIYAR RISES WITH SAYYID SUPPORT · 1719 DEPOSITION AND ENTHRONEMENTS · 1720 SAYYIDS FALL · 1724 NIZAM'S HYDERABAD AUTONOMY

1707 Aurangzeb dies → Bahadur Shah I 1707-12 → Jahandar Shah 1712-13 → 1713 Farrukhsiyar rises with Sayyid support → 1719 deposition and enthronements → 1720 Sayyids fall → 1724 Nizam's Hyderabad autonomy → 1739 Karnal and Delhi → 1740s → regional bargaining and frontier pressure; later Durrani/Panipat stay bounded.

CORE CLAIM
- 1707 Aurangzeb dies → Bahadur Shah I 1707-12 → Jahandar Shah 1712-13
- 1713 Farrukhsiyar rises with Sayyid support → 1719 deposition and enthronements

MECHANISM
- 1720 Sayyids fall → 1724 Nizam's Hyderabad autonomy → 1739 Karnal and Delhi
- 1740s → regional bargaining and frontier pressure; later Durrani/Panipat stay bounded.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1707 Aurangzeb dies → Bahadur Shah I 1707-12 → Jahandar Shah 1712-13
- 1713 Farrukhsiyar rises with Sayyid support → 1719 deposition and enthronements

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1740s → regional bargaining and frontier pressure; later Durrani/Panipat stay bounded.

02

STAGE 02

SUCCESSION INSTABILITY: THRONE BECOMES A PRIZE

SUCCESSION INSTABILITY · THRONE BECOMES A PRIZE · NO FIXED PRIMOGENITURE · PRINCES MOBILISE HOUSEHOLDS AND NOBLE CLIENTS · SUCCESSION WAR · VICTORY REALLOCATES MANSAB, JAGIR AND OFFICE · REPEATED CONTEST · EMPEROR CANNOT CREDIBLY ARBITRATE ELITE COMPETITION

NO FIXED PRIMOGENITURE → princes mobilise households and noble clients

SUCCESSION WAR → victory reallocates mansab, jagir and office → REPEATED CONTEST → emperor cannot credibly arbitrate elite competition → RESULT → political transmission fails; it is a mechanism, not a lone cause.

CORE CLAIM
- NO FIXED PRIMOGENITURE → princes mobilise households and noble clients
- SUCCESSION WAR → victory reallocates mansab, jagir and office

MECHANISM
- REPEATED CONTEST → emperor cannot credibly arbitrate elite competition
- RESULT → political transmission fails; it is a mechanism, not a lone cause.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NO FIXED PRIMOGENITURE → princes mobilise households and noble clients
- SUCCESSION WAR → victory reallocates mansab, jagir and office

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → political transmission fails; it is a mechanism, not a lone cause.

03

STAGE 03

FACTIONS AND THE SAYYID MOMENT

FACTIONS AND THE SAYYID MOMENT · SHIFTING PATRONAGE FORMATIONS · FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 · SAYYID BROTHERS SUPPLY MILITARY-POLITICAL SUPPORT · KINGMAKING EXPOSES THE THRONE'S DEPENDENCE ON COALITION CONTROL · SAYYIDS REMOVED; FACTIONAL POLITICS SURVIVES THE TWO INDIVIDUALS.

CORE CLAIM
- TURANI / IRANI / AFGHAN / HINDUSTANI → shifting patronage formations
- FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 → Sayyid Brothers supply military-political support

MECHANISM
- 1719 → kingmaking exposes the throne's dependence on coalition control
- 1720 → Sayyids removed; factional politics survives the two individuals.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- TURANI / IRANI / AFGHAN / HINDUSTANI → shifting patronage formations
- FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 → Sayyid Brothers supply military-political support

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1720 → Sayyids removed; factional politics survives the two individuals.

04

STAGE 04

JAGIRDARI VOCABULARY PREVENTS CATEGORY ERRORS

JAGIRDARI VOCABULARY PREVENTS CATEGORY ERRORS · TRANSFERABLE REVENUE ASSIGNMENT, NOT PRIVATE LANDOWNERSHIP · ASSESSED CLAIM · REALISED COLLECTION · RESERVE ASSIGNABLE POOL · USABLE JAGIR SHORTAGE · NOMINAL ASSESSMENT NEVER AUTOMATICALLY MEASURES TREASURY CASH OR WELFARE.

JAMA → assessed claim	HASIL → realised collection
PAIBAQI → reserve assignable pool	BE-JAGIRI → usable jagir shortage

CORE CLAIM
- JAGIR → transferable revenue assignment, not private landownership
- JAMA → assessed claim

MECHANISM
- HASIL → realised collection
- PAIBAQI → reserve assignable pool

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BE-JAGIRI → usable jagir shortage
- TRAP → nominal assessment never automatically measures treasury cash or welfare.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → nominal assessment never automatically measures treasury cash or welfare.

05

STAGE 05

FISCAL-MILITARY FEEDBACK LOOP

FISCAL-MILITARY FEEDBACK LOOP · MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI · SCRAMBLE FOR PRODUCTIVE JAGIRS · SHORT TENURE · RESISTANCE, EVASION, FLIGHT OR NEGOTIATION · LOWER HASIL · UNPAID CONTINGENTS AND WEAKER IMPERIAL SERVICE · WEAKER CONTROL

MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI → scramble for productive jagirs → SHORT TENURE / EXTRACTION → resistance, evasion, flight or negotiation → LOWER HASIL → unpaid contingents and weaker imperial service → WEAKER CONTROL → regional retention of revenue → still lower central capacity.

CORE CLAIM
- MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI → scramble for productive jagirs
- SHORT TENURE / EXTRACTION → resistance, evasion, flight or negotiation

MECHANISM
- LOWER HASIL → unpaid contingents and weaker imperial service
- WEAKER CONTROL → regional retention of revenue → still lower central capacity.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI → scramble for productive jagirs
- SHORT TENURE / EXTRACTION → resistance, evasion, flight or negotiation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WEAKER CONTROL → regional retention of revenue → still lower central capacity.

06

STAGE 06

AURANGZEB'S LEGACY: A WEIGHTED BACKGROUND

AURANGZEB'S LEGACY · A WEIGHTED BACKGROUND · DECCAN WAR · GARRISONS, TRANSPORT, REMOUNTS AND UNRESOLVED MARATHA CHALLENGE · TERRITORY AND CLAIMS GROW FASTER THAN RELIABLE REALISATION · NORTH ABSENCE · STRAINS OF SUPERVISION AND ARBITRATION · LEGACY MATTERED, BUT AURANGZEB ALONE CANNOT EXPLAIN POST-1707 FACTIONS

DECCAN WAR → garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge

ANNEXATIONS → territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation → NORTH ABSENCE → strains of supervision and arbitration → QUALIFY → legacy mattered, but Aurangzeb alone cannot explain post-1707 factions or regions.

CORE CLAIM
- DECCAN WAR → garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge
- ANNEXATIONS → territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation

MECHANISM
- NORTH ABSENCE → strains of supervision and arbitration
- QUALIFY → legacy mattered, but Aurangzeb alone cannot explain post-1707 factions or regions.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DECCAN WAR → garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge
- ANNEXATIONS → territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFY → legacy mattered, but Aurangzeb alone cannot explain post-1707 factions or regions.

07

STAGE 07

AGRARIAN AND REGIONAL ASSERTION

AGRARIAN AND REGIONAL ASSERTION · REVENUE PRESSURE · ZAMINDARS, PEASANTS AND INTERMEDIARIES BARGAIN OR RESIST · GOVERNORS + BANKERS + ARMED FOLLOWINGS · PROVINCIAL RESOURCE CONTROL · JAT MOBILISATION · DISTINCT POLITICAL ROUTES, NOT ONE REBELLION · DELHI'S WEAKENING AND REGIONAL STATE-MAKING REINFORCE EACH OTHER.

REVENUE PRESSURE → zamindars, peasants and intermediaries bargain or resist

GOVERNORS + BANKERS + ARMED FOLLOWINGS → provincial resource control → MARATHA / SIKH / JAT mobilisation → distinct political routes, not one rebellion → RESULT → Delhi's weakening and regional state-making reinforce each other.

CORE CLAIM
- REVENUE PRESSURE → zamindars, peasants and intermediaries bargain or resist
- GOVERNORS + BANKERS + ARMED FOLLOWINGS → provincial resource control

MECHANISM
- MARATHA / SIKH / JAT mobilisation → distinct political routes, not one rebellion
- RESULT → Delhi's weakening and regional state-making reinforce each other.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- REVENUE PRESSURE → zamindars, peasants and intermediaries bargain or resist
- GOVERNORS + BANKERS + ARMED FOLLOWINGS → provincial resource control

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → Delhi's weakening and regional state-making reinforce each other.

08

STAGE 08

SUCCESSOR-STATE SPECTRUM

SUCCESSOR-STATE SPECTRUM · MURSHID QULI KHAN · SAADAT KHAN · IMPERIAL OFFICE · LOCAL REVENUE, ARMY AND PATRONAGE BECOME DURABLE · FORMAL MUGHAL LEGITIMACY MAY REMAIN USEFUL · AUTONOMY IN SUBSTANCE DOES NOT REQUIRE A MODERN DECLARATION

CORE CLAIM
- BENGAL → Murshid Quli Khan
- AWADH → Saadat Khan

MECHANISM
- HYDERABAD → Nizam-ul-Mulk
- IMPERIAL OFFICE → local revenue, army and patronage become durable

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- COIN / KHUTBA / TITLE → formal Mughal legitimacy may remain useful
- TRAP → autonomy in substance does not require a modern declaration of independence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → autonomy in substance does not require a modern declaration of independence.

09

STAGE 09

NADIR SHAH: SHOCK EXPOSES A PRIOR CRISIS

NADIR SHAH · SHOCK EXPOSES A PRIOR CRISIS · FRONTIER WEAKNESS + PERSIAN MILITARY CAPACITY · INVASION OPPORTUNITY · KARNAL, 24 FEBRUARY 1739 · FRAGMENTED COMMAND LOSES TO UNIFIED COMMAND · SACK, TREASURY LOSS AND PRESTIGE SHOCK; MUHAMMAD SHAH REMAINS · ACCELERANT AND REVEALER, NOT THE ORIGINAL CAUSE OF DECLINE.

FRONTIER WEAKNESS + Persian military capacity → invasion opportunity → KARNAL, 24 FEBRUARY 1739 → fragmented command loses to unified command → DELHI → sack, treasury loss and prestige shock; Muhammad Shah remains emperor → VERDICT → accelerant and revealer, not the original cause of decline.

CORE CLAIM
- FRONTIER WEAKNESS + Persian military capacity → invasion opportunity
- KARNAL, 24 FEBRUARY 1739 → fragmented command loses to unified command

MECHANISM
- DELHI → sack, treasury loss and prestige shock; Muhammad Shah remains emperor
- VERDICT → accelerant and revealer, not the original cause of decline.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- FRONTIER WEAKNESS + Persian military capacity → invasion opportunity
- KARNAL, 24 FEBRUARY 1739 → fragmented command loses to unified command

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → accelerant and revealer, not the original cause of decline.

10

STAGE 10

INSTITUTIONAL CONTINUITY AFTER CONTRACTION

INSTITUTIONAL CONTINUITY AFTER CONTRACTION · SYMBOLIC ARBITRATION AND LEGAL VOCABULARY · COIN + KHUTBA · LAYERED LEGITIMACY · PERSIAN CHANCERY · PORTABLE ADMINISTRATION · INSTITUTIONS REPURPOSED IN REGIONAL ARENAS · CONTINUITY OF FORM COEXISTS WITH CHANGE IN WHO COMMANDS

EMPEROR / FARMAN / SANAD → symbolic arbitration and legal vocabulary

COIN + KHUTBA → layered legitimacy → PERSIAN CHANCERY → portable administration → MANSAB / DIWAN / ZAMINDAR → institutions repurposed in regional arenas

CORE CLAIM
- EMPEROR / FARMAN / SANAD → symbolic arbitration and legal vocabulary
- COIN + KHUTBA → layered legitimacy

MECHANISM
- PERSIAN CHANCERY → portable administration
- MANSAB / DIWAN / ZAMINDAR → institutions repurposed in regional arenas

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RULE → continuity of form coexists with change in who commands resources.
- EMPEROR / FARMAN / SANAD → symbolic arbitration and legal vocabulary

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → continuity of form coexists with change in who commands resources.

11

STAGE 11

TOPIC 01 ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 01 ANSWER SPINE · CENTRAL FISCAL-MILITARY COMMAND DECLINED INSIDE A CONTINUING POLITICAL CULTURE · SUCCESSION + FACTION + JAGIR-AGRARIAN STRAIN + REGIONAL ASSERTION · DECCAN LEGACY MATTERS; REJECT AURANGZEB-ONLY MONOCAUSALITY · NADIR 1739 EXPOSES WEAKNESS; CONTINUITY AND REGIONAL VARIATION QUALIFY · STOP CORE CHRONOLOGY IN THE 1740S.

OPEN → central fiscal-military command declined inside a continuing political culture → EXPLAIN → succession + faction + jagir-agrarian strain + regional assertion → WEIGH → Deccan legacy matters; reject Aurangzeb-only monocausality → TEST → Nadir 1739 exposes weakness; continuity and regional variation qualify conclusion → CLOSE → stop core chronology in the 1740s.

CORE CLAIM
- OPEN → central fiscal-military command declined inside a continuing political culture
- EXPLAIN → succession + faction + jagir-agrarian strain + regional assertion

MECHANISM
- WEIGH → Deccan legacy matters; reject Aurangzeb-only monocausality
- TEST → Nadir 1739 exposes weakness; continuity and regional variation qualify conclusion

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE → stop core chronology in the 1740s.
- OPEN → central fiscal-military command declined inside a continuing political culture

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEST → Nadir 1739 exposes weakness; continuity and regional variation qualify conclusion.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · THE DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE (1707–1740S) — ADVANCED · 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA · 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION · 3. STUDY LINKS · 4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS) · 5. UPSC TRAPS · 6. CURRENT LINK

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- The Decline of the Mughal Empire (1707–1740s) — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data

ADVANCED DEBATE
- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link

LEGACY / NUANCE
- 7. Mains angles
- + Historiography note (PYQ-gap)
- Bipin Chandra frames decline as structural , not merely a matter of "bad kings"; the jagirdari and agrarian crisis was central.
- The number of nobles (mansabdars) and their claims outran the supply of revenue-yielding jagirs , producing a scramble

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels